

3D Wax printing

3D printing hardware can now start using wax to create models, the first prototype has been successful <http://dgit.in/3DWaxPrint>



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GALAXY GTX 660 GC 2GB

When we look at the NVIDIA cards we noticed that there is a huge disparity in pricing in the current generation. The GTX 750 Ti comes in at ₹11,990 and the very next card which happens to be the GTX 760 starts at ₹18,570. So there is a 6.5K difference between these two cards which is filled with previous generation units. AMD also has a similar pricing pattern between the R9 270X and the R9 280X with a similarly vast 6K gap in pricing.

This is a common tactic which allows manufacturers to slowly transition out from

only SKU. The retail GTX 660 which you can buy has a different configuration than the OEM SKU and performs much lower which makes it a no brainer decision to go with the GTX 760. With AMD, you face a similar situation since the R9 270X and the HD 7870 are equally priced. Therefore, going in for the improved R9 270X in this case is an easy decision to make.

Build quality

We saw some decently built cards this year and that too in the mid-range segment. ASUS

well and fine but when you start charging a price premium for doing nothing then things stop making any sense and . Moreover, reference designs from both AMD and NVIDIA aren't capable of keeping low temperatures without ramping up the noise level. The cooler designs are barely sufficient since the load temperatures often frolick around the lower 80s in the reference de-

this time, after all it is based on the Tahiti chip and that too a fully enabled one. Other than minor modifications it is essentially a Radeon HD 7970 which was the flagship card in the last test. So when the flagship gets a price cut and drops down into the upper mid-range segment it's pretty much given that it is going to win hands down. The ZOTAC 770 AMP! Edition came real close and the ASUS



MSI N770 TwinFrozeR

sign ,thus, keeping the fans at a perpetual high RPM state.

A rather irritating aspect that we noticed in plenty of cards this year was the placement and orientation of the power connectors. The release tabs were pointing inwards which made them difficult to unhook. It's taken for granted that cards once installed are unlikely to be removed regularly but it's still irksome to handle when using SLI.

R9 280X even topped the performance of this card but couldn't make it to the podium because of a higher price which exceeded the parameters set for this comparison test.

As for second place, the MSI N770 Twin FrozeR came really close to winning first place but unfortunately it didn't score well in the OpenGL test which gave the AMD card a significant lead. Had this been a purely gaming focused bench-



ZOTAC GTX 760 AMP! Edition

a generation, however, this gap also counts for the sweet spot that most gamers go for. The performance between the OEM GTX 660 and the retail GTX 760 is moderate but the price difference doesn't scale proportionally in India. The OEM GTX 660 and the retail GTX 760 are based off the same Kepler chip but you can't get the fully enabled GTX 660 for sale since that is an OEM

has maintained a good standard of having a better coolers on almost all cards. The direct CU coolers seem to be doing their job quite well and the overall choice of materials on the card makes them sturdy yet moderately heavy. MSI is another brand which seems to be paying extra attention to their card. Most manufacturers don't bother fiddling with the reference design and that's



XFX R9 280X



Winners Best Performer

It wasn't a surprise that the XFX R9 280X takes the crown

mark the MSI card would have actually won hands down. The two cards are well built but the MSI card ran at hotter tempera-